All future forms: plans.

Will, going to, arrangements, and timetables - the complete core set from our lessons.

Will

An immediate decision, offer, promise, or prediction.

+ will + base verb
- will not / won't + base verb
? Will + subject + base verb?

Common clues: I think, probably, perhaps; a decision made now

Example: That bag looks heavy. I will carry it.

I think she will win is a prediction. A time word such as tomorrow does not choose will automatically.

Be going to

An earlier intention or a prediction based on present evidence.

+ am/is/are going to + base verb
- am/is/are not going to + base verb
? Am/Is/Are + subject + going to + base verb?

Common clues: a prior plan; visible evidence now

Example: Look at those clouds. It is going to rain.

We are going to try yoga describes an intention. It need not be a confirmed arrangement.

Present Continuous: future

An arrangement that is already agreed or organised.

+ am/is/are + verb-ing
- am/is/are not + verb-ing
? Am/Is/Are + subject + verb-ing?

Common clues: a future time + an agreed person, place, or booking

Example: We are meeting Jo at seven tomorrow.

The context gives a future meaning. The same form can also describe an activity happening now.

Present Simple: future

Schedules, timetables, and future time clauses.

+ base verb / verb-s; am/is/are
- do/does not + base verb
? Do/Does + subject + base verb?

Common clues: timetables; when, after, before, until, by the time

Example: The train leaves at nine tomorrow.

Time clause: When she arrives, I will call you. Normally no will after when in this use.

Future meaning is bigger than one tense.

Will: I will help (decision now). **Going to:** I am going to help (earlier intention).
Arrangement: I am meeting the team at ten. **Timetable:** The meeting starts at ten.
These meanings can overlap. Explain the intended focus instead of treating every alternative as an error.

Reference: British Council: future forms. Examples written for this guide.

All future forms: viewpoints.

A snapshot, a completed result, or the length of an activity up to a future point.

Future Continuous

An activity underway at a future moment; also an expected course of events.

+ will be + verb-ing
- will not / won't be + verb-ing
? Will + subject + be + verb-ing?

Common clues: at eight tomorrow, this time next week

Example: At eight tomorrow, I will be flying to Rome.

A snapshot of the flight in progress; the sentence does not state its total duration.

Future Perfect Simple

A completed result or a state lasting up to a future viewpoint.

+ will have + past participle (V3)
- will not / won't have + V3
? Will + subject + have + V3?

Common clues: by Friday, by then, by the time; completed totals

Example: By six, I will have edited three scenes.

Also: By May, I will have known her for ten years. Know is a state, so use the simple form.

Future Perfect Continuous

Duration or process viewed from a future moment.

+ will have been + verb-ing
- will not / won't have been + verb-ing
? Will + subject + have been + verb-ing?

Common clues: for, since, how long; by then / by the time

Example: By six, I will have been editing for four hours.

The start may be before now or later. Duration does not guarantee completion; normal breaks can occur.

One task, three questions

Choose the message before choosing the form.

Snapshot What will be happening?
Result What will be complete?
Duration How long will it have been going on?

Common clues: at a moment = snapshot; by a moment = look back

Example: At six: I will be editing.
By six: I will have edited three scenes.
By six: I will have been editing for four hours.

At/by are helpful, but meaning decides. By does not automatically mean Future Perfect Simple.

Two final checks.

Time clause: By the time the doors **open**, we will have been rehearsing for hours.
States: will have known / owned, normally not will have been knowing / owning.
For = duration; **since** = starting point. Living/working can allow both perfect forms, with a different focus.

Reference: Cambridge: Future Perfect Continuous and British Council: future viewpoints.